National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Gallup, NM	**Accident Number:**	DEN08CA043
Date & Time:	12/22/2007, 1755 MST	**Registration:**	N8305V
Aircraft:	Champion 7GCAA	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	2 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

According to the pilot, during the night landing he flared too high, the airplane stalled, and impacted the runway with the nose canted to the right. He said that he added power in attempt to straighten the airplane, but the airplane departed the runway to the right, traveled through a ditch and nosed over, resulting in substantial damage. The pilot reported no anomalies with the airplane systems. He stated he was not night current, and did not hold a valid medical certificate.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's premature landing flare and an inadvertent stall/mush. A contributing factor is pilot's lack of recent night experience.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - IN FLIGHT
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Findings
1. (C) FLARE - PREMATURE - PILOT IN COMMAND
2. (F) LACK OF RECENT EXPERIENCE IN TYPE OPERATION - PILOT IN COMMAND
3. (C) STALL/MUSH - INADVERTENT - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: IN FLIGHT COLLISION WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: DESCENT - UNCONTROLLED

Findings
4. TERRAIN CONDITION - RUNWAY

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	68, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	None None	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	5 hours (Total, all aircraft), 5 hours (Total, this make and model), 5 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Champion	**Registration:**	N8305V
Model/Series:	7GCAA	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Restricted; Normal	**Serial Number:**	98
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	3
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	Unknown	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320
Registered Owner:	Brown Consulting and Sales Inc	**Rated Power:**	180 hp
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Night
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KGUP, 6472 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	1 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	1753 MST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	60°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	3 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	230°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.31 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	-4°C / -11°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	CEDAR CITY, UT (CDC)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Gallup, NM (GUP)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	1530 MST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	GALLUP MUNICIPAL (GUP)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	6472 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	6	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	7316 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Full Stop

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	2 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	35.500833, -108.783889

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Jennifer S Kaiser	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Bruce Jeffcoat; FAA Flight Stanards District Office; Albuquerque, NM		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.